

Level 5 Operations Manager v1.4 Qualification/EPA Assessment Specification

Introduction

Welcome to the CMI Qualification Specification document for the [Operations manager](#) Apprenticeship Standard. This specification provides information on CMI's approach and delivery of the end point assessment for this Standard, in line with the requirements of the published assessment plan.

Please refer directly to the [assessment plan](#) for any further details; these include, but are not limited to:

- Apprenticeship Summary - A reflection of the occupational standards and its end point assessment delivery
- Occupational Standard - size, types and broad summary of occupational organisations, with the roles and duties expected, and examples of typical job titles
- EPA plan in its entirety - detailed overview of programme process, end point assessment delivery, grading and quality assurance practices expected

Overview

This version of the standard for Operations manager replaced version 1.3 for any new apprentice starters on or after the 25th September 2024, which we do/did not deliver due to its short approval time; 19/09/2024 to 24/09/2024.

Occupational Standard	Apprenticeship Qualification Title	Ofqual Qualification Reference Number
ST Code: ST0385	Operations manager v1.4	610/0208/2
Original Date Approved For Delivery: 01/06/2016 - 03/03/2019 v1.0 v1.1 04/03/2019 to 20/10/2020 v1.2 21/10/2020 to 18/09/2024 v1.4 Latest version: 25/9/2024 Typical duration to Gateway (excluding EPA period): 24 months Maximum funding: £9000		

What is it?	The Operations Manager standard is designed to develop the knowledge, skills, and behaviours for an operations manager.
How is it delivered?	End Point Assessment (EPA) is provided at the latter stages of an apprenticeship programme, post Gateway. It is conducted by CMI as the End Point Assessment Organisation (EPAO), via a Live Assessment Day using two assessment methods. The Assessment is conducted virtually by an Independent Apprenticeship Assessor (IAA).
How is it assessed?	- Assessment method 1: Project with report (includes a written project report and a presentation with questions and answers) . Grades are Fail, Pass & Distinction - Assessment method 2: Professional discussion underpinned by a portfolio of evidence . Grades are Fail, Pass & Distinction Overall grades follow the assessment plan specifications and require both assessment methods to be combined to decide the overall apprenticeship grade. The Assessment methods are equally weighted and available for the apprentice as Fail, Pass & Distinction Apprentices must be successful in achieving their end point assessment in order to be awarded the above apprenticeship.
Who is the target end user?	Individuals working as or aspiring to be an Operations Manager. Example progression routes include Chartered manager (degree) or Senior leader.

The Apprenticeship Journey

The end to end apprenticeship journey is expected to be split into the following 3 stages set out in the [assessment plan](#)

Stage 1:

The Apprentice, Training Provider and Employer should be directed to read the introduction and overview section of the [assessment plan](#) to understand the expectations and timelines involved in this stage.

Completing The On-Programme Assignments, Modules, and Activities - typically 24 months

- developing knowledge, skills, and behaviours
- development of English and maths, if required
- building a portfolio of evidence

Stage 2:

At Gateway, apprentices must submit:

- A portfolio of evidence for the professional discussion, typically containing 16 discrete pieces of evidence.
- Evidence of a completed on-programme project, which will form the basis of their written project report in the EPA.
- Confirmation from the employer, supported by the training provider, that the project completed on programme is a significant and defined piece of work that has real business application and benefit.
- Evidence of English and maths achievement, when required by the apprenticeship funding rules. Any organisation-specific policies and procedures requested by the EPAO.

Stage 3:

Undertaking the End Point Assessment (EPA)

The End Point Assessment is taken in the EPA period, This starts when CMI confirms the gateway requirements have been met and is typically 5 months, this is the final stage of the actual apprenticeship journey and contains:

- Assessment Method 1: Written project report with presentation and questioning with an Independent Apprenticeship Assessor appointed by CMI
- Assessment Method 2: Professional Discussion with an Independent Apprenticeship Assessor appointed by CMI, and underpinned by a portfolio of evidence.

Typical duration of end point assessment: 5 months culminating in the live assessment activity, typically taking no more than 3 hours.

Assessment Plan application:

Order of Assessment methods:

The Assessment plan states that the assessment methods can be completed in any order; at CMI we believe that the presentation should be conducted first, thus we conduct the Live assessment in this order:

- **Assessment method 1 - Project with report:** The apprentice must start the written project report after the gateway. The report must have a word count of 4000 words (with a 10% tolerance). The apprentice must submit the report and presentation materials by the end of week 12 of the EPA period. The presentation with questions must last 60 minutes (typically a 20-minute presentation and 40 minutes of questioning).
- **Assessment method 2 - Professional discussion:** This is underpinned by a portfolio of evidence, which is used by the assessor to prepare questions but is not directly assessed. The professional discussion must last for 60 minutes.

The CMIAssess portal is used to administer both Gateway and End Point Assessment; the functions include:

1. Booking Live assessment days
2. Gateway documentation
3. A student page to provide the project documentation specified, and the timelines involved in the EPA period
4. Processing of the results

Overall grading decision

The Apprentice is required to successfully complete and pass BOTH assessment methods to achieve a Pass or Distinction grade. If one or more assessment methods is deemed a fail, then a resit or retake must be conducted in order to achieve a grade capped at a Pass. Further information can be found on the [assessment plan](#) under the Overall EPA guidance section.

The overall grading result will normally be communicated to the Training Provider within 15 working days of the Apprentice concluding their live assessment.

Please note that:

- All Fail results are communicated to the Employer, Apprentice, and Training Provider
- If the apprentice fails one assessment method or more, they can take a re-sit or a re-take at their employer's discretion.
- A re-sit is typically taken within 2 months of the EPA outcome notification, while a re-take is typically taken within 3 months.
- If the apprentice fails the project assessment method, they must amend the project output in line with the independent assessor's feedback and will be given 4 weeks to rework and submit the amended report.
- The apprentice will get a maximum EPA grade of a pass if they need to re-sit or re-take, unless the EPAO determines there are exceptional circumstances.

Further Information

The difference between a resit and a retake can be found in the [assessment plan](#), under the re-sits and re-takes heading, with more details on the specific timelines dictated

Assessment Plan specifications:

The EPAO ensures that the EPA materials are subject to quality assurance procedures including standardisation and moderation.

All CMI End Point Assessment Policy and Procedural documents can be located on our website.

Reasonable Adjustments:

CMI is committed to ensuring that end point assessment is a fair assessment of an apprentice's knowledge, skills and behaviors. Should any apprentice require a reasonable adjustment, we require notification in advance; apprentices should ensure that their Training Provider is made aware of any reasonable adjustment requests so that applications can be submitted at least 4 weeks in advance of any planned live assessment day.